

D176

Content Marketing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A payroll-software company with offices in Denver and Austin publishes a free, detailed guide on how small businesses can avoid the five most common payroll tax penalties. The guide mentions the product only once, at the end. The company's logo was redesigned last year. What is this an example of?

- A. Advertising.
- B. Earned media.
- C. Brand identity work, because of the new logo.
- D. Content marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which piece is advertising rather than content marketing?

- A. A free checklist for preparing a year-end budget.
- B. A paid banner saying "Switch today and save 20%."
- C. Any content published on a company blog.
- D. A how-to video on setting up a home office.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A regional credit union's marketing team, excited by a competitor's popular podcast, wants to launch its own next month. The team has a new \$3,000 microphone. No one has defined who the audience is or what the podcast should achieve. What should come first?

- A. Copy the competitor's format, since it is already popular.
- B. Record a pilot episode to test the new microphone.
- C. Launch on schedule and figure out the audience from downloads.
- D. Define the target audience persona and the business goal the podcast must serve.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A hospital-software vendor sees that a clinic manager, who has worked in healthcare for 20 years, has already read several articles on reducing patient no-shows and is now comparing scheduling tools. The vendor's booth at last month's trade show was busy. Which content should the vendor offer next?

- A. A contract and pricing sheet for immediate signing.
- B. An introductory article on why no-shows matter.
- C. A comparison guide or webinar on how scheduling tools differ.
- D. An invitation to next year's trade show.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A prospect has narrowed a choice to two vendors and asks for proof that your product works for companies like hers. Which content fits best?

- A. A brand video about company history.
- B. A general blog post on industry trends.
- C. An e-book comparing all solution types.
- D. A case study from a similar customer with measured results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A home-improvement retailer spent \$40,000 on a how-to video series last year. Tracking shows \$100,000 in sales attributed to the series. The videos were filmed in the retailer's flagship store in Atlanta. What was the content ROI?

- A. 150%
- B. 40%
- C. 250%
- D. \$60,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A content program costs \$25,000. Leadership wants a 200% ROI. How much attributed revenue must it produce?

- A.** \$75,000
- B.** \$200
- C.** \$50,000
- D.** \$12,500

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A nonprofit's in-depth research report on local food insecurity took three months to write and includes 40 charts. After it was posted on the website, it drew only 150 visits in a month. The executive director was recently interviewed on local radio. What is the most likely fix?

- A.** Rewrite the report, since low traffic proves it is poor.
- B.** Wait; quality content is always found eventually.
- C.** Build a distribution plan: email subscribers, partner shares, social posts and short repurposed pieces that link back.
- D.** Add more charts to make it more complete.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A meal-planning app is testing email subject lines. The app was built by a team of six in Chicago. Which subject line best follows benefit-driven copywriting?

- A.** "Our app now features AI-powered recipe algorithms."
- B.** "Built by six people in Chicago."
- C.** "Get dinner on the table in 20 minutes — every night this week."
- D.** "Download, share, rate, follow and subscribe!"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A landing page ends with five buttons: Download, Subscribe, Share, Contact Sales and Follow Us. Conversions are low. What is the best copy fix?

- A.** Add two more buttons to give readers more choice.
- B.** Keep one clear call to action tied to the page's goal.
- C.** Remove all calls to action so readers are not pressured.
- D.** Change the button colors only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A cybersecurity firm with 300 employees wants to be seen as the authority on ransomware for mid-sized companies. Its office has a new rooftop garden. Which approach builds the most credible authority?

- A.** Publish an annual report based on its own incident data, written by named security experts with cited sources.
- B.** Post five short, generic articles a day to dominate search.
- C.** Feature the rooftop garden in its blog.
- D.** Publish sponsored articles without labeling them as sponsored.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A fitness brand's blog has 60 separate posts on strength training, many targeting nearly the same keywords, with no links between them. The blog's editor holds a personal-trainer certification. Traffic has stalled. What structure should it adopt?

- A.** Publish 60 more posts on the same keywords.
- B.** Create a pillar page on strength training that links to focused cluster posts, which link back to it.
- C.** Add the editor's certification to every post.
- D.** Delete every post and start over.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A payroll-software company ~~with offices in Denver and Austin~~ publishes a free, detailed guide on how small businesses can avoid the five most common payroll tax penalties. The guide mentions the product only once, at the end. ~~The company's logo was redesigned last year.~~ What is this an example of?

Target word: classify the piece **Decides:** Useful content that helps the reader without requiring a purchase.

A	Inverted operation	Advertising leads with a paid product message.
B	Confusion set	The company created and owns the guide.
C	Camouflage	The logo change is unrelated.
D	Correct	Value-first content that attracts the target audience.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which piece is advertising rather than content marketing?

Target word: reverse: pick the non-example **Decides:** Pushes the product rather than helping the reader.

A	Inverted operation	Helpful and non-promotional — content marketing.
B	Correct	Interruptive product promotion is advertising.
C	Absolute language	Blog posts can be either; the test is value versus pitch.
D	Adjacent category	Educational content, not a sales message.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A regional credit union's marketing team, excited by a competitor's popular podcast, wants to launch its own next month. ~~The team has a new \$3,000 microphone.~~ No one has defined who the audience is or what the podcast should achieve. What should come first?

Target word: first step in strategy **Decides:** Audience and goals are undefined.

A	Adjacent category	A rival's audience and goals may not match.
B	Camouflage	Equipment does not set direction.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the order: audience first, then content.
D	Correct	Strategy precedes format and production.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A hospital-software vendor sees that a clinic manager, ~~who has worked in healthcare for 20 years,~~ has already read several articles on reducing patient no-shows and is now comparing scheduling tools. ~~The vendor's booth at last month's trade show was busy.~~ Which content should the vendor offer next?

Target word: match content to stage **Decides:** She is comparing solutions — consideration stage.

A	Adjacent category	Decision-stage content; she has not narrowed to one vendor.
B	Inverted operation	Awareness content; she is past that.
C	Correct	Consideration content helps evaluate solutions.
D	Camouflage	The trade show is irrelevant to her stage.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A prospect has narrowed a choice to two vendors and asks for proof that your product works for companies like hers. Which content fits best?

Target word: reverse: content for the decision stage **Decides:** She wants proof before choosing.

A	Confusion set	Does not provide the proof requested.
B	Inverted operation	Awareness content.
C	Adjacent category	Consideration content; she has already narrowed the field.
D	Correct	Decision-stage proof.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A home-improvement retailer spent \$40,000 on a how-to video series last year. Tracking shows \$100,000 in sales attributed to the series. ~~The videos were filmed in the retailer's flagship store in Atlanta.~~ What was the content ROI?

Target word: ROI percent **Decides:** $(\$100,000 - \$40,000) \div \$40,000$.

A	Correct	$\$60,000 / \$40,000 = 1.5$.
B	Inverted operation	Divides cost by revenue.
C	Dropped element	Revenue / cost; leaves out subtracting cost.
D	Adjacent category	That is net return in dollars, not ROI.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A content program costs \$25,000. Leadership wants a 200% ROI. How much attributed revenue must it produce?

Target word: solve for revenue **Decides:** $\text{Revenue} = \text{cost} \times (1 + \text{ROI})$.

A	Correct	$\$25,000 \times 3 = \$75,000$; $(\$75,000 - \$25,000) / \$25,000 = 200\%$.
B	Wrong stem number	Reads the percentage as dollars.
C	Dropped element	Gives \$50,000 of return but forgets to add back the cost.
D	Inverted operation	Divides cost by 2.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A nonprofit's in-depth research report on local food insecurity took three months to write ~~and includes 40 charts.~~ After it was posted on the website, it drew only 150 visits in a month. ~~The executive director was recently interviewed on local radio.~~ What is the most likely fix?

Target word: fix for low reach **Decides:** Good content lacked a distribution plan.

A	Inverted operation	Low reach reflects distribution, not necessarily quality.
B	Absolute language	Content without promotion is often never found.
C	Correct	Content needs active distribution and repurposing.
D	Camouflage	Chart count does not drive discovery.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A meal-planning app is testing email subject lines. ~~The app was built by a team of six in Chicago.~~ Which subject line best follows benefit-driven copywriting?

Target word: benefit-led copy **Decides:** Lead with what the reader gains.

A	Inverted operation	Leads with a feature, not the benefit.
B	Camouflage	Team details do not tell readers what they gain.
C	Correct	States a clear, specific reader benefit.
D	Dropped element	Several competing calls to action and no benefit.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A landing page ends with five buttons: Download, Subscribe, Share, Contact Sales and Follow Us. Conversions are low. What is the best copy fix?

Target word: reverse: diagnose the CTA problem **Decides:** Too many competing calls to action.

A	Inverted operation	More options add confusion.
B	Correct	A single, specific CTA reduces friction.
C	Absolute language	Without any CTA, readers have no next step.
D	Adjacent category	Design tweaks do not fix competing CTAs.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A cybersecurity firm ~~with 300 employees~~ wants to be seen as the authority on ransomware for mid-sized companies. ~~Its office has a new rooftop garden.~~ Which approach builds the most credible authority?

Target word: authority-building approach **Decides:** Original, expert, well-sourced content.

A	Correct	Original data and visible expertise build authority and trust.
B	Adjacent category	Volume without substance does not build authority.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant to ransomware authority.
D	Inverted operation	Hidden sponsorship destroys trust.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A fitness brand's blog has 60 separate posts on strength training, many targeting nearly the same keywords, with no links between them. ~~The blog's editor holds a personal trainer certification.~~ Traffic has stalled. What structure should it adopt?

Target word: site content structure **Decides:** Related posts need a hub and internal links.

A	Inverted operation	Adds to the overlap problem.
B	Correct	Topic clusters organize content and reduce keyword competition among posts.
C	Camouflage	Credentials help trust but do not fix the structure.
D	Absolute language	Existing posts can be consolidated and linked.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	12	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Content marketing vs. advertising	Content marketing attracts and keeps an audience by giving useful, relevant content first; advertising interrupts to push a message about the product.	Calling a product pitch “content marketing” because it appears on a blog.	Does the piece help the audience without them buying, or does it sell?
2	Audience and goals before creation	A content strategy starts with a defined audience (persona), a content mission and measurable business goals; topics and formats follow.	Starting with a format or trend (a podcast, a viral video) before defining audience and goal.	A team eager to produce something before knowing who it is for.
3	Mapping content to the buyer’s journey	Awareness content educates about a problem; consideration content compares solutions; decision content proves the vendor (case studies, demos, pricing).	Sending a hard-sell demo offer to someone who just learned the problem exists.	What the reader already knows and what they are trying to decide.
4	Measuring content with ROI	Content ROI = (attributed revenue – content cost) ÷ content cost; choose metrics that match the goal (consumption, sharing, leads, sales).	Dividing revenue by cost and calling it ROI, or judging a lead-gen goal by page views.	Program cost and attributed revenue in the same stem.
5	Distribution and repurposing	Great content still needs a distribution plan across owned, earned and paid channels; one core asset can be repurposed into many formats.	Assuming good content will be found on its own.	Strong content with little traffic.
6	Benefit-driven copy and calls to action	Lead with what the reader gains (benefits), support with features, and end with one clear, specific call to action.	Listing technical features and several competing calls to action.	A choice among headlines or CTAs for a piece of copy.
7	Authority and trust	Content builds authority through original insight, named expertise, accurate sourcing and consistency; trust is lost through errors, hidden sponsorship or exaggeration.	Believing volume of posts alone builds authority.	A choice between more content and more credible content.
8	Pillar pages and topic clusters	A pillar page covers a broad topic and links to cluster pages that go deep on subtopics, which link back; this organizes the site for readers and search.	Publishing many unlinked posts on overlapping keywords that compete with each other.	A large set of related posts with no hub or internal links.

Course scope (public description): Content Marketing examines how organizations create and distribute marketing communications to attract and retain customers. Students will gain knowledge of the content planning process and how content marketing supports brand and organizational goals by learning how to create, distribute, promote, and measure relevant and valuable content. Students will learn content ideation and will write compelling copy that creates relationships with customers to build trust and enhance an organization’s reputation and authority.